

present in the moment while still keeping tabs on important information that we've come to expect our phones to provide us. Yes, I love the improvements to the Glyph Interface. But is it complete? No, not even close. There could be a LOT more functionality added, but it feels like Nothing has taken several steps in the right direction with the Nothing Phone (2).

PERFORMANCE

The Phone (2) has seen a considerable price bump, but not without some serious hardware upgrades. One of these upgrades is the processor. The Phone (2) is powered by the Qualcomm Snapdragon 8+ Gen 1 processor, an undeniable improvement over its predecessor's mid-range Snapdragon 778G+ SoC.

In AnTuTu, the phone scored more than 1.2 million, easily beating out phones such as the Google Pixel 7a and OPPO Reno 10 Pro+. In fact, its score is very close to the flagship Galaxy S23 Ultra as well! In GeekBench, the phone flew past the scores of the Pixel 7a and OPPO Reno10 Pro+ once again, but the iQOO Neo 7 Pro – which is much cheaper – managed to squeak out slightly better scores in some CPU tests. Not in PCMark Work though, where the Nothing Phone (2) beat out all three phones.

In GPU benchmarks, the phone scored 2,800 points in 3D Mark Wild Life Extreme, which is excellent. However, it couldn't squeeze out great scores in GFXBench – particularly Manhattan 3.1 – where it lagged behind the competition. Nevertheless, real world gaming is smooth and lag-free on Very High graphics settings. The phone doesn't support High Frame Rate gaming though (at launch), it is capped to 60 fps.

Additionally, the clean Nothing OS 2.0 is incredibly smooth and fluid. It is a slightly modified version of stock Android 13 and it looks and feels incredible. Nothing OS 2.0 allows for tons of customisation in terms of custom widgets, monochrome icons, Quick Set-

tings widgets, and lock screen widgets. There's no bloatware – only the mandatory Google apps, and some custom apps such as the Camera, Composer, Weather, Nothing X (for earphones) and Voice Recorder apps.

CAMERA

Despite sporting improved cameras, this is one of the weakest links of the Nothing Phone (2). That's evident after you spend time with the Phone (2)'s camera after playing around with flagship offerings. Sure, the phone can take some amazing shots in daylight with plenty of detail, low noise, and good levels of sharpness. However, I always found the dynamic range to be slightly lacking, even in good lighting. I found that the details in shadows can get crushed quite often. Also, the colours are a touch too saturated and skin tones aren't accurate to real life as well.

Portrait shots from the main lens are mediocre. The edge detection isn't the best and the skin tones aren't accurate – at least for Indians. The bokeh looks pleasant though.

The ultrawide photos look good. Noise is low and colours match the primary camera. However, once again, the dynamic range is lacking. The 32 MP selfie camera's results are decent with low noise and good contrast. The colours are decent and the dynamic range is quite good.

Moving on to low light, this mode triggers automatically and there's no way to control it manually. A missed opportunity, in my opinion, since some photos end up looking dark even with Night Mode active. The photos are good enough in most cases, but we noticed some results looking quite soft and noisy. Definite room for improvement here.

BATTERY LIFE

The Nothing Phone (2) comes with an upgraded battery over the Phone (1) with higher capacity – 4,700 mAh vs 4,500 mAh. The chipset is also known to be extremely efficient and with AOD turned

off, the Phone (2) delivered spectacular battery life results. In our 4K video loop test, the phone lasted a whopping 18 hours and 2 minutes, which is one of the best results at this price.

The Phone (2) also supports 45 W wired fast charging which powers the phone from zero to hundred in 57 minutes, according to our tests. There's also support for 15 W wireless charging.

VERDICT

The Nothing Phone (2) is truly something special. It has taken a phone that was essentially all-looks-no-substance and turned it into a well-rounded device with looks and utility to match. Not just that, Nothing OS 2.0 is possibly one of my absolute favourite mobile phone operating systems – it looks distinguished, classy, and clean while being fluid all the way through. The performance has improved vastly and battery life is superb as well. Now, for the price tag of ₹44,999 going all the way up to ₹54,999, the phone may seem overpriced to some. The Snapdragon 8+ Gen 1 is present on much cheaper phones such as the iQOO Neo 7 Pro and the camera stack is nothing to write home about.

However, Nothing has charged you a premium for the experience, which, in my opinion, it delivers in spades. The experience is fluid and refined with no bloatware, the once-gimmicky glyphs have some actual functionality now, and there are other niceties like the premium body and design.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: Qualcomm Snapdragon 8+ Gen 1 | GPU: Adreno 730 | RAM: Up to 12 GB | Internal storage: Up to 512 GB | OS: Android 13, Nothing OS 2 | Battery: 4,700 mAh | Charging: 45 W wired, 15 W wireless, 5 W reverse wireless | Cameras (rear): 50 MP Sony IMX890 (OIS + EIS) + 50 MP Samsung JN1 ultrawide | Selfie camera: 32 MP Sony IMX615 | Video: Up to 4K at 60 fps (rear), Up to 1080p at 60 fps (front) | Display: 6.7-inch LTPO AMOLED display, up to 120 Hz Adaptive refresh rate | Weight: 201.2 g

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